

All DSLRs aboard the eye3

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World's largest videogame controller

Students in the Netherlands have created the world's largest videogame controller. Wonder how it would be to play using it?
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MFD comparison test

change the darkness level of the prints, etc. And since the MFD also comes with fax support you also get a phonebook (Most of the laser MFDs in our comparison allowed you to control everything from the control panel itself, an important highlight).

While most of the Laser MFDs come with a two-line LCD screen, the Canon MF4420w has a 5-line LCD, this makes it very easy to read and navigate the UI, which is easy to use.

Another very common feature with laser MFDs is the manual feed slot – for unusual paper sizes – envelopes, etc. All the MFDs from Brother, Panasonic and Dell support this feature.

Ease of use

Installing the toner cartridges is a very easy affair on all the MFDs and shouldn't pose a problem for anyone.

The keys on the control panel of the HP Laserjet Pro M1213NF MFP feel a bit too stiff to press. Surprisingly, the HP also lacks

CONTROL PANEL

Look for MFDs with a control panel that allows you to perform all the tasks from the printer itself. This makes the MFD extremely convenient and quick to use

a dedicated scan button on the control panel. This means you'll have to rely on the PC to take scans. In the Canon MF4420w setting up the Wi-Fi is quite easy but entering the passcodes is a challenge, since it doesn't come with a physical keyboard. We had to use the four-way scroll button to scroll to each letter and then select it – it was a pain, to say the least.

With the Panasonic KX-MB1520, the UI isn't all that user-friendly. Lack of a back button makes it difficult to use the MFD until you get a hang of it. The overall interface is a bit difficult for the initial setup but once done you should be good to go. The paper loading tray isn't all that smooth when we tried to load it – it may become a cumbersome task over time.

The Canon MF3010 has a very unique con-



Epson K300: Hands down the best built MFD we saw during the course of this test

trol panel; it has a 7 Segment (1 digit) LED that does the work of a screen (But since there's nothing to display on the screen apart from letters, it becomes really difficult to use the MFD out of the box). Using the control panel will need you to thoroughly go through the entire manual before using it. Even with this Canon MFD you find that the a dedicated scan button is missing on the control panel.

Among the rest of the MFDs in the bunch, the Epson MX14 and the Dell 1135n frequently heated up. The problem with the Dell 1135n was that it always performed a warm-up program if we were to use it even after a short idle time. This got annoying after a while.

Winner

According to our tests, Epson AcuLaser CX17NF wins the **Best Performer** award. The Epson CX17NF was the only colour laser LED MFD we

received and as none of the other brands had a laser LED colour MFD to offer under 20K, the Epson AcuLaser CX17NF had a massive advantage.

With the best price to performance ratio the Epson MX14, wins our **Best Buy** award. It gave much better performance than the Epson AcuLaser CX17NF on most tests, and was much faster to boot. ■



Epson AcuLaser CX17NF: Holds the distinction of being the only LED colour MFD under ₹20,000 in this test



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